each limited their capacity when engaged by well-armed Indian forces. This also helped minimize the body count in the hotels where potential victims were able to disperse and hide. The number of dead easily could have been much higher at the hotels considering the length of the operation and large number of potential victims present. Because terrorism is a form of expressive violence intended to induce repercussions far beyond those immediately victimized by it, the operational success of the Mumbai attacks cannot be measured by body account alone. The fact that they were so successful owed partly to a seriously flawed Indian counter-terrorism response.

US officials issued several warnings to their Indian counterparts about various aspects of the attack. The first came in early 2008 and contained general intelligence regarding Lashkar's ambition to strike Mumbai. A second, more specific, warning followed in May 2008 and included information that the Taj might be a target. A third alert regarding the Taj was issued in September, at approximately the time when the attacks initially were intended to take place. Finally, on 18 November, days before the fidayeen finally set sail, US officials issued a warning to India about a suspicious vessel believed to pose a potential maritime threat.[45] RAW immediately disseminated a specific advisory to the coast guard requesting it intensify patrols and look out for suspicious vessels, most likely of Pakistani origin. However, the MV *Kuber* blended in with the thousands of other Indian-registered fishing vessels.[46] Monitoring an expansive coastline is a challenge facing many littoral states, but this was compounded by a dearth of resources necessary for coastal surveillance. The committee that investigated the attacks found the Maharashtra government took no significant measures to improve coastal security despite repeated alerts.[47] There were fewer than 100 boats guarding over 5,000 miles of shoreline at the time of the attacks, and Maharashtra State had refused money set aside by the central government for the purchase of twenty-six additional vessels because it lacked the funds necessary for maintenance.[48]

India was hardly the first country to have prior warning of a terrorist attack and yet remain powerless to stop it. Connecting the dots is always easier in hindsight. More troubling was the degree to which the various security forces in India were unprepared to respond to the attacks once they began. After the September warning, hotel security and the police